Client Finder Agent FREE

QUICK-START GUIDE

Client Finder Lite

Set up the free workflow and get your first list of local businesses in about 10 minutes.

Version 1.0.0 · Tested on n8n 1.123.83 and 2.42.3

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What Client Finder Lite does

Client Finder Lite is the free version of Client Finder Agent. You type a business type and a city into a simple web form. The workflow searches Google Maps and gives you a CSV file (a simple spreadsheet file) of up to 60 local businesses.

Businesses with **no website** come first, so Lite is a good fit for web designers: the businesses at the top may need their first website. Each row has the phone, website (if any), rating, reviews, address and a Maps link. Closed businesses and duplicates are removed.

Lite uses Google's official Places API with your own key, not a scraper, and it never contacts anyone for you. Google's Maps Platform Terms (section 3.2.3) restrict storing Places content such as business names and addresses outside Google's services (Place IDs may be kept), so read the terms, treat your CSV as a working list and delete leads you don't pursue.

What you need

You need	Notes
An n8n account	n8n is a tool that runs automations, called workflows. Use an n8n Cloud free trial, or self-hosted n8n version 1.123 or newer.
A Google account	Any Gmail or Google Workspace account works.
A payment card	Google asks for one before it turns on Maps services. Step 1 explains why.
About 10 minutes	Most of it is spent in Google Cloud.

Step 1: Get a Google API key in Google Cloud

An API key is like a password that lets a program (here, n8n) use a Google service.

1.1 Create a project

1. Go to `console.cloud.google.com` and sign in.
2. Click the project picker at the top, then **New Project**.
3. Name it `Client Finder` and click **Create**. Make sure it is selected at the top.

1.2 Attach billing and set a budget alert

Google requires a billing account for Maps services, even inside the free monthly usage. Without one, searches fail.

1. Open the menu (three lines, top left) and click **Billing**.
2. Click **Link a billing account** (or **Create billing account**) and add your card.
3. Open **Budgets & alerts** and click **Create budget**.
4. Choose a small amount, for example 5 in your currency. Keep the default alerts and click **Finish**.

> **Important:** A budget alert only sends you an email. It does not stop spending.

1.3 Enable Places API (New)

1. Open the menu and go to **APIs & Services** > **Library**.
2. Search for `Places API (New)`, open it and click **Enable**.

> **Warning:** Google also lists an older "Places API" without "(New)". Lite needs **Places API (New)**.

1.4 Create and restrict the API key

1. Go to **APIs & Services** > **Credentials**.
2. Click **Create credentials** > **API key**. Copy the key.
3. Click the key's name to open its settings.
4. Under **Application restrictions**, choose **None**. n8n runs on a server, so website or app restrictions would block it.
5. Under **API restrictions**, choose **Restrict key**, tick **Places API (New)** and click **OK**.
6. Click **Save**. Changes can take a few minutes to work.

If Google shows these options while you create the key, choose the same settings there.

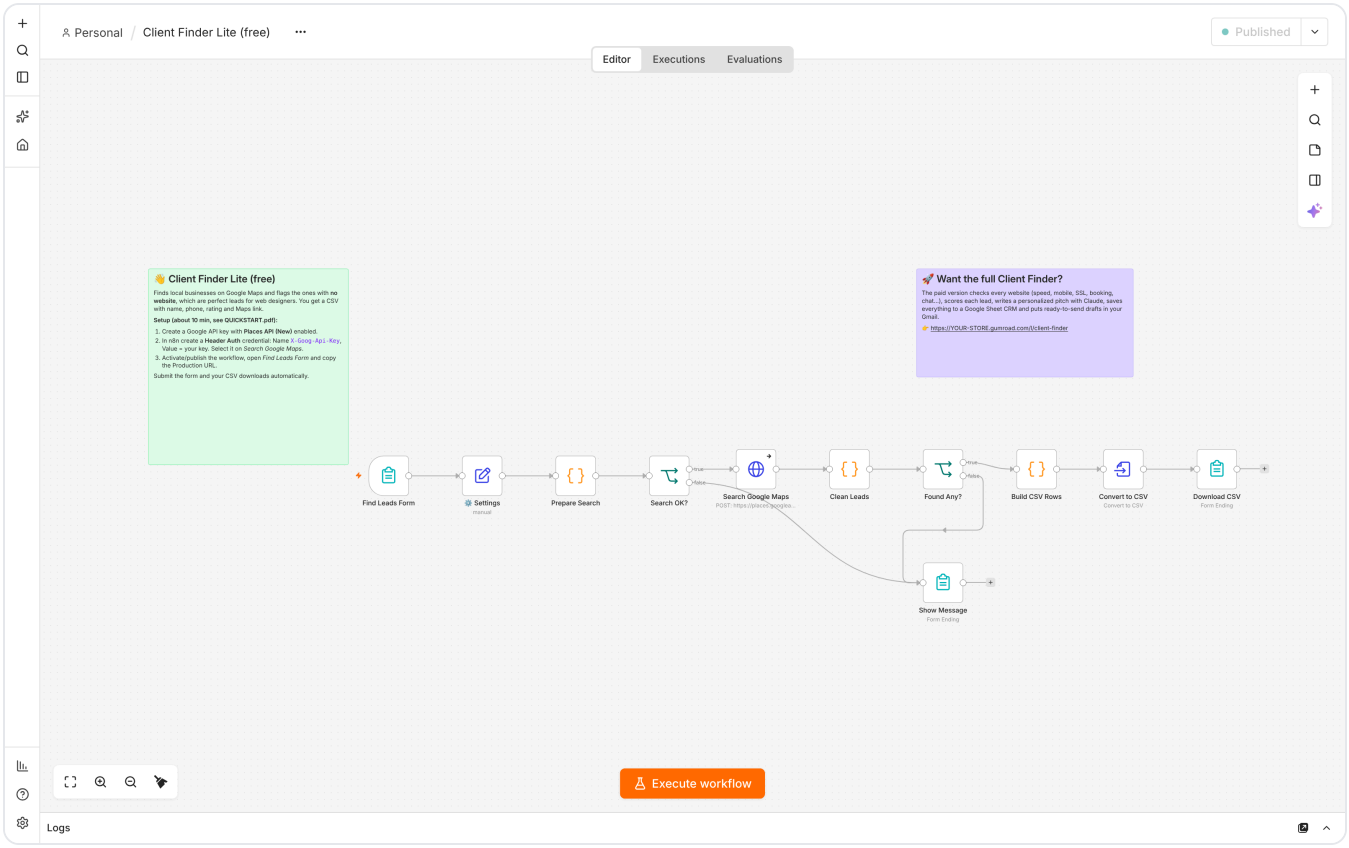
> **Warning:** Treat the key like a password. If it leaks, delete it on the **Credentials** page and create a new one.

Step 2: Import the workflow into n8n

1. In n8n, go to your **Workflows** list.
2. Click **Create Workflow** (in some versions **Create** > **Workflow**, or **+**). An empty canvas opens: the area where the workflow's boxes, called nodes, sit.

3. Open the workflow menu, the **...** button (next to the workflow name in n8n 2.x, at the top right in n8n 1.x), and choose **Import from File...**.
4. Select `client-finder-lite.json` from your download. If you see a **Save** button, click it.

Another way: open the JSON file in a text editor, copy everything, click the empty canvas and paste (Ctrl+V or Cmd+V).

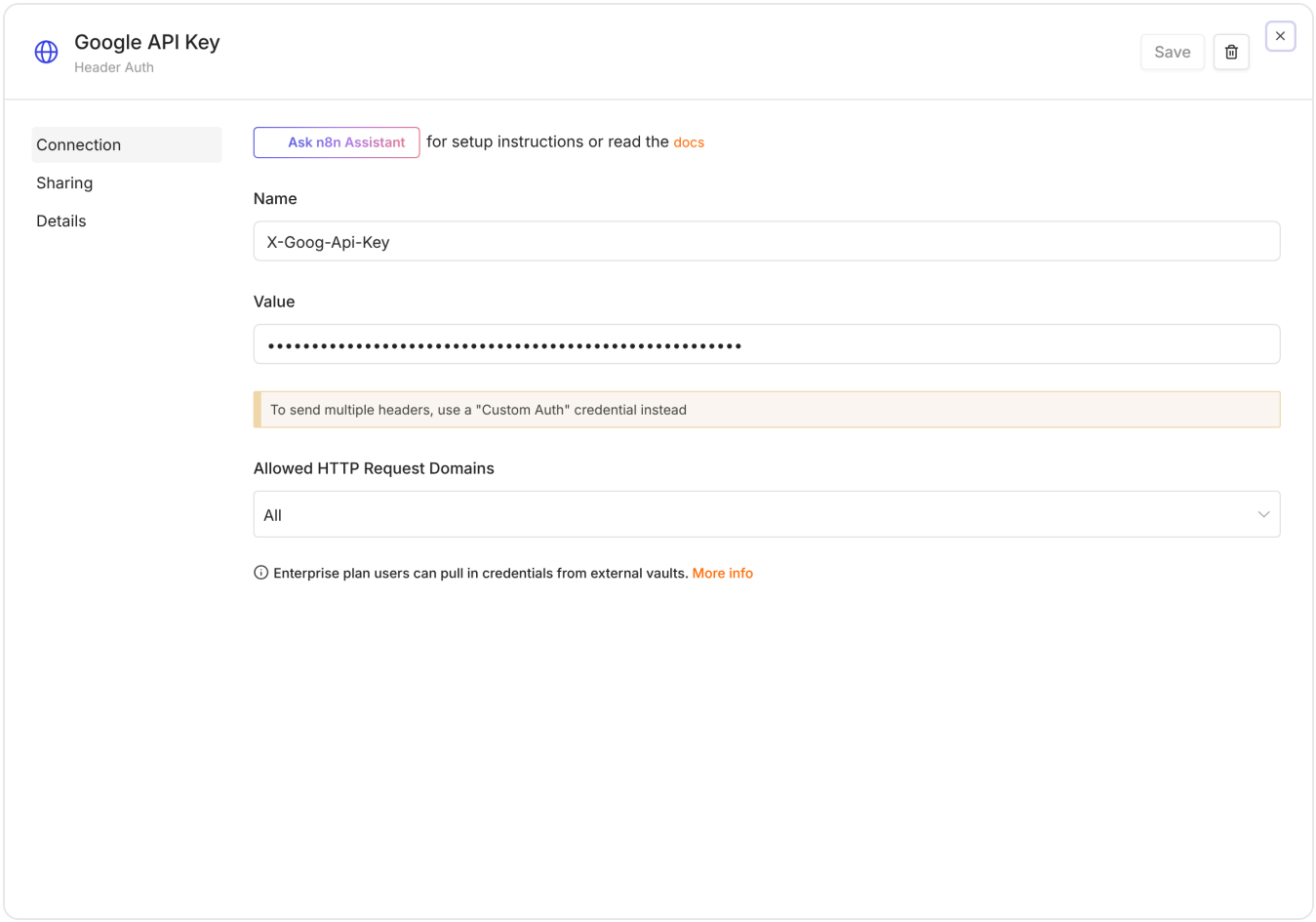


The Lite workflow after import. The "Start Here" note repeats the setup steps.

Step 3: Connect your Google API key

A credential is a key or login that n8n stores safely for your workflows.

1. Double-click the *Search Google Maps* node.
2. Leave **Authentication** (**Generic Credential Type**) and **Generic Auth Type** (**Header Auth**) as they are.
3. Open the **Credential for Header Auth** list and choose **Create new credential**.
4. In **Name**, type `X-Goog-Api-Key` exactly. A header is a hidden label sent with each request; Google looks for your key under this name.
5. In **Value**, paste your API key, with no spaces before or after it.
6. Click the title at the top of the dialog and rename the credential to `Google API Key`.
7. Click **Save** and close the dialog. *Search Google Maps* now shows **Google API Key**.



Name is X-Goog-Api-Key, Value is your key.

Step 4: Turn it on and run your first search

4.1 Activate or publish

The form's public address only works when the workflow is switched on.

- **n8n 1.x:** click the **Inactive** toggle at the top right so it shows **Active**.
- **n8n 2.x:** click **Publish** at the top right.

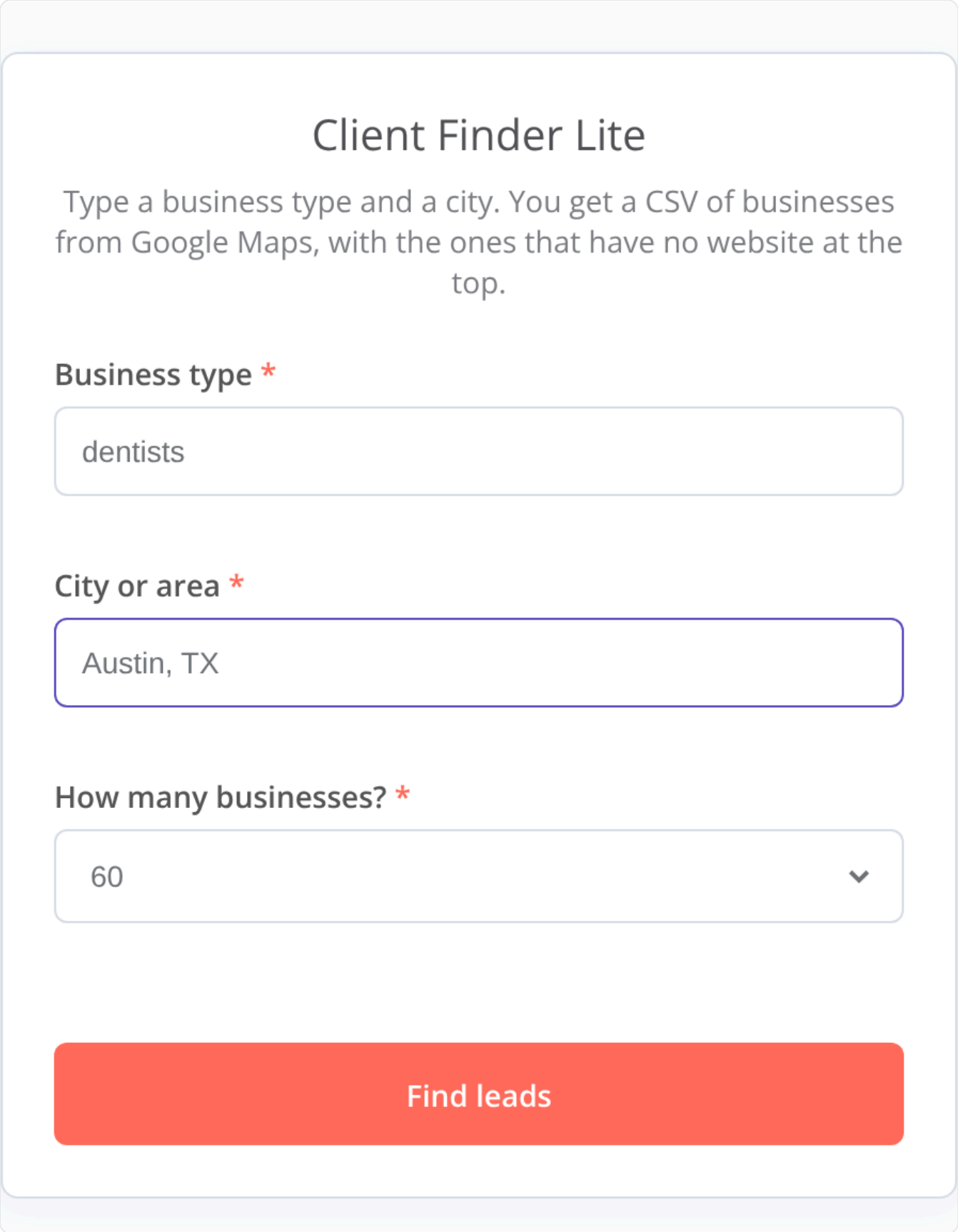
If n8n refuses, look for a node with a red warning icon. Usually *Search Google Maps* has no credential yet.

4.2 Copy the form address

1. Double-click *Find Leads Form*.
2. At the top, switch from **Test URL** to **Production URL**.
3. Click the address to copy it. It ends in `/form/client-finder-lite`.
4. Open it in a new browser tab and bookmark it.

Warning: Anyone with the Production URL can run searches on your Google account. Keep it private, and lock the form: in *Find Leads Form*, set **Authentication** to **Basic Auth** and create a credential with a username and password. You can also change **Options** > **Form Path** to something hard to guess (then copy the new Production URL). On n8n 2.x, publish again afterwards.

4.3 Fill in the form



The form you fill in for every search.

1. **Business type**: for example `dentists` or `hair salons`.
2. **City or area**: for example `Austin, TX`, `Manchester, UK` or `Pune, India`.
3. **How many businesses?**: choose **20**, **40** or **60**.
4. Click **Find leads**.

After a few seconds, the page says **Your leads are ready** and the CSV downloads, for example `leads-dentists-in-austin-tx.csv`. For more than 60 businesses, also search nearby areas or related business types.

> **Tip:** Results in the wrong country or language? In ⚙️ *Settings*, set `searchCountryCode` (for example `US`, `GB`, `IN`) or `searchLanguage` (for example `en`). On n8n 2.x, publish again afterwards.

Step 5: Use your CSV

Open the file

- **Google Sheets:** open a blank sheet, then **File** > **Import** > **Upload**, choose the file and click **Import data**.
- **Excel:** double-click the file. If accented names look wrong, use **Data** > **From Text/CSV** and choose **UTF-8**.

The columns

Column	What it shows
Business	The name on Google Maps
Has Website	**NO** if Google lists no website, **Yes** if it does. If Google only links to a social, booking, delivery or directory page, it shows, for example, **NO (Facebook page only)**. Sites made with a site builder (for example Google Sites or square.site) count as **Yes**
Opportunity	"No website: pitch a website" (or, for example, "Only a Facebook page: pitch a website") for businesses marked NO
Phone, Website	As listed on Google Maps (Website is empty if none)
Category	The main category, for example "Dentist"
Rating, Reviews	Google star rating (1 to 5) and number of reviews

Column	What it shows
Address, Google Maps	The address on Google Maps and a link to the Maps listing
Search	The search you ran, for example "dentists in Austin, TX"
Source	Always "Google Maps", where the data came from

Businesses marked NO come first. Within each group, businesses with more reviews come first. The search also includes service-area businesses (plumbers, cleaners, mobile trades without a storefront), so a few rows may have no street address.

A value that starts with `=`, `+`, `-` or `@` (for example a phone number like "+1 512...") gets an apostrophe (') in front, so spreadsheet apps don't run it as a formula. If you see that apostrophe, that is why.

> **Example:** These rows are example data from our test set (made-up businesses in Austin, TX), not real results.

Business	Has Website	Phone	Rating	Reviews
Lakeside Dental Care	NO	(512) 555-0102	4.8	340
Sunrise Family Dental, PLLC	Yes	(512) 555-0101	4.6	212

Start with the businesses marked NO

A business with good reviews but no website is a good place to start: it has happy customers, but nothing for new ones to look at.

1. "NO" means Google Maps lists no website of their own (at most a social, booking, delivery or directory page). A few may still have one, so search the name first.
2. Open the Maps link and note one real detail to mention.
3. Add a **Status** column to track who you contacted and when.

A first message you can send

Lite does not find email addresses. Call, or send a direct message (DM) on Facebook, Instagram or WhatsApp. If their Google or Facebook page shows an email address, send the same text by email.

> **Example:** Hi [name], I found [Business] on Google Maps and saw your [340] reviews. Great work. I couldn't find a website for you, though, and many people like to see one before they call. I build simple, mobile-friendly websites for local businesses. Would a free one-page idea of what yours could look like be useful? If not, no problem. [Your name], [your phone]

On the phone, keep it short: "Hi, I'm [name], a web designer in [city]. I saw your reviews on Google Maps, but I couldn't find your website. Do you have one I missed?" Then listen.

> **Important:** Be honest and polite, and stop if someone says no. Follow the rules for cold calls and messages in your country.

Troubleshooting

When something goes wrong, the form shows a message page instead of a download.

"Google Maps search failed"

The message also gives a reason:

The reason mentions	What to do
your Google API key was rejected	Open the Google API Key credential, paste the key again, and check that **Name** is exactly `X-Goog-Api-Key`.
this API is not enabled	Enable **Places API (New)** in the key's project (Step 1.3). Wait 2 minutes and try again.
billing account	Link a billing account to the project (Step 1.2).
restricted to other APIs	Open the key in **Credentials** and, under **API restrictions**, tick **Places API (New)** and click **Save** (Step 1.4). The message also names PageSpeed Insights API: only the paid versions use it, and ticking it too does no harm.
an application restriction	Set **Application restrictions** to **None** and keep the key restricted by API instead (Step 1.4).
quota or rate limit	Wait a few minutes and try again.
permission denied	Check the key and that Places API (New) is enabled in the key's project.

Some messages mention the "Google Cloud" step of the setup guide. In this quick start, that is Step 1.

"No businesses found"

Google Maps found no open businesses for your search. Try a bigger area (a city instead of a neighbourhood), check the spelling, or use a more common business type.

"Missing search details"

Business type or **City or area** was empty or only had spaces. Fill in both and submit again.

The form address shows a 404 or "not found" error

The workflow is not switched on: activate or publish it (Step 4.1), and use the **Production URL**. If you imported Lite twice, delete the extra copy: both use the same address, so only one can be active.

Still stuck? Email support@example.com with the exact message and your n8n version. Never send your API key.

What it costs

- **Lite is free.** It uses no AI and no paid add-ons.
- **Google Places API:** one request returns up to 20 businesses. A 20-business search is 1 request, 40 is up to 2, and 60 is up to 3.
- Google's free monthly usage for Maps services usually covers light use. Prices change, so check the current Places API (New) Text Search prices at https://mapsplatform.google.com/pricing/.
- **n8n:** n8n Cloud is paid after the trial. Self-hosted n8n is free software on your own server. Each search is one workflow run (an "execution").

> **Cost:** For a hard limit, lower the daily request quota of Places API (New) in Google Cloud.

Want the full Client Finder?

The paid versions also research each business and draft your first message. The checks are careful but not perfect, so you read and send every email yourself.

Starter ($49 USD) is the web-design Client Finder. It:

- Checks each business's website for problems you can fix (down, slow on mobile, not mobile-friendly, no HTTPS, outdated and more). When a check can't be sure, it makes no claim.
- Scores each business from 0 to 100 (Hot, Warm or Low).
- Writes a short pitch with Claude (an AI model), using only problems it actually verified.
- Saves everything to a Google Sheet CRM (a simple customer list). It skips businesses already in the sheet and never pitches the same email address or website twice.

- Creates Gmail drafts when a business publishes an email address on its homepage. Nothing is sent until you send it.

Pro ($99 USD) adds:

- 5 niche workflows: web design, local SEO, Google reviews, social media and ads, and AI chatbots and booking.
- Follow-up Autopilot: every morning it checks Gmail, marks replies and bounced emails in your sheet and drafts polite follow-ups in the same thread.
- An outreach playbook and message templates.

The one-time setup for either version takes about 30 to 45 minutes the first time.

> **Cost:** The paid versions also need an Anthropic API key with prepaid credits, roughly 1 to 2 US cents per pitch with the default settings.

Get Starter or Pro here: https://YOUR-STORE.gumroad.com/l/client-finder